

Higher Education and Research English Participant Workbook

Practice pages for realistic field-specific meetings, pushback, documentation, and role-play preparation

Audience: faculty, postdoctoral researchers, graduate students, lab managers, research administrators, grant staff, ethics-board coordinators, and academic program leaders

Focus: A higher education and research English curriculum for grant proposals, lab meetings, peer review, research ethics, authorship, data management, academic presentations, and institutional collaboration.

Designed for advanced ESL learners who already use professional English and need industry-specific terminology, realistic meetings, role-play pressure, careful pushback, and polished workplace outputs.

Teaching stance: this is language and workplace-communication training, not legal, medical, financial, safety, or regulatory advice. Instructors should connect every scenario to the learner's current company policies, local rules, and approved procedures.

How to Use This Workbook

For each module, read a workplace scenario and complete a bounded dialogue. Choose one of four options, then use the answer key to see why the selected phrase fits the evidence, risk, owner, and next step.

Module 1. Research Questions and Study Design

Situation

A lab wants to describe an exploratory study as definitive.

Stakeholder pressure: Use stronger language to attract attention.

Constraint: Hypothesis, design, sample, limitations, and inference must be aligned.

Terms to use

- research question
- hypothesis
- methodology
- limitation

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

A lab wants to describe an exploratory study as definitive.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Use stronger language to attract attention.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm research question, hypothesis, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	scope
B	timeline
C	study-design caveat
D	owner

Module 2. Grant Proposals and Specific Aims

Situation

A proposal includes too many objectives for the budget.

Stakeholder pressure: Keep every aim to look comprehensive.

Constraint: Feasibility, significance, innovation, approach, and milestones need balance.

Terms to use

- specific aims
- significance
- innovation
- feasibility

Guided dialogue completion**Situation**

A proposal includes too many objectives for the budget.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Keep every aim to look comprehensive.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm specific aims, significance, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	scope
B	timeline
C	specific-aims revision
D	owner

Module 3. Lab Meetings and Data Challenges**Situation**

A student presents inconsistent results.

Stakeholder pressure: Say the data are bad.

Constraint: Controls, replication, protocol drift, and analysis assumptions need review.

Terms to use

- control
- replication
- protocol drift

- analysis assumption

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

A student presents inconsistent results.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Say the data are bad.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm control, replication, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	timeline
B	lab-meeting question set
C	owner
D	scope

Module 4. Research Ethics and Human Subjects

Situation

A researcher wants to use data for a new question outside the approved protocol.

Stakeholder pressure: Analyze it because the data already exist.

Constraint: Consent, IRB approval, privacy, and secondary-use rules may apply.

Terms to use

- IRB
- informed consent
- secondary use
- human subjects

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

A researcher wants to use data for a new question outside the approved protocol.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Analyze it because the data already exist.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm IRB, informed consent, the owner, and the evidence standard.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	owner
B	scope
C	timeline
D	ethics consultation note

Module 5. Authorship, Collaboration, and Credit

Situation

A collaborator expects authorship after a small advisory role.

Stakeholder pressure: Agree to avoid conflict.

Constraint: Contribution, criteria, order, acknowledgments, and publication norms must be explicit.

Terms to use

- authorship
- contribution
- corresponding author
- acknowledgment

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

A collaborator expects authorship after a small advisory role.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Agree to avoid conflict.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm authorship, contribution, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	specific-aims revision
B	lab-meeting question set
C	authorship agreement draft

Option	Phrase
D	study-design caveat

Module 6. Peer Review and Revision Responses

Situation

Reviewers ask for additional analyses outside the original scope.

Stakeholder pressure: Reject the comment sharply.

Constraint: Tone, evidence, scope, feasibility, and transparent limitations matter.

Terms to use

- peer review
- major revision
- response letter
- scope

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

Reviewers ask for additional analyses outside the original scope.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Reject the comment sharply.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm peer review, major revision, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	evidence
B	risk
C	owner
D	reviewer-response paragraph

Module 7. Data Management and Reproducibility

Situation

A dataset lacks clear metadata before publication.

Stakeholder pressure: Upload it anyway.

Constraint: Metadata, code, provenance, privacy, and repository requirements need attention.

Terms to use

- metadata
- repository
- provenance
- reproducibility

Guided dialogue completion**Situation**

A dataset lacks clear metadata before publication.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Upload it anyway.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm metadata, repository, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	assumption
B	mitigation
C	data-management checklist
D	timeline

Module 8. Academic Presentations and Conferences**Situation**

A conference audience challenges the study's generalizability.

Stakeholder pressure: Defend every conclusion.

Constraint: Population, context, method, and future work should be addressed calmly.

Terms to use

- generalizability
- limitation
- future work
- conference Q&A

Guided dialogue completion**Situation**

A conference audience challenges the study's generalizability.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Defend every conclusion.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm generalizability, limitation, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	timeline
B	conference Q&A response
C	owner
D	scope

Answer Key and Rationale

Check each answer after completing the dialogue. The rationale shows why the correct phrase is the strongest fit for the real workplace situation.

Research Questions and Study Design

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. study-design caveat	A study-design caveat is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Grant Proposals and Specific Aims

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. specific-aims revision	A specific-aims revision is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Lab Meetings and Data Challenges

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. lab-meeting question set	A lab-meeting question set is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Research Ethics and Human Subjects

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. ethics consultation note	A ethics consultation note is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Authorship, Collaboration, and Credit

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. authorship agreement draft	A authorship agreement draft is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Peer Review and Revision Responses

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. reviewer-response paragraph	A reviewer-response paragraph is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Data Management and Reproducibility

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. data-management checklist	A data-management checklist is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Academic Presentations and Conferences

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. conference Q&A response	A conference Q&A response is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.